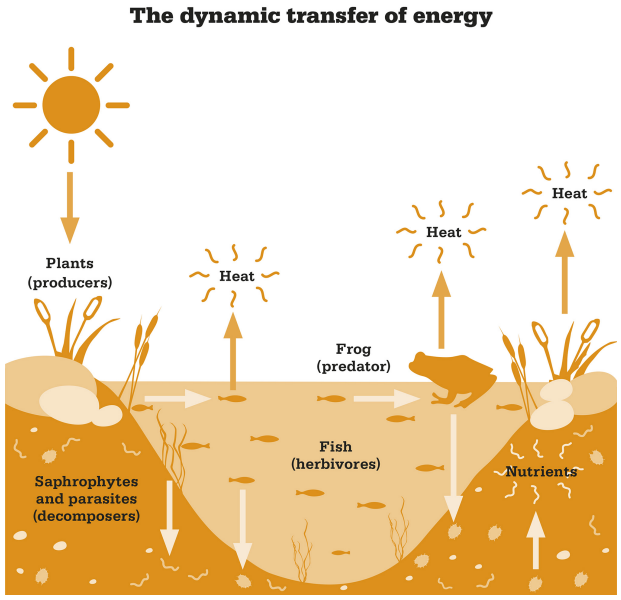


The dynamic transfer of energy.

The Sun provides energy to plants (producers), which pass it to fish (herbivores) and then to a frog (predator). Saphrophytes and parasites (decomposers) recycle nutrients from organic matter back to the soil. Nutrients are also cycled back into the ecosystem through decomposition. At each stage, some energy is lost as heat.

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